@CHECKSMATEDAILY

30 Chess Traps for 400–1000 Elo

Win fast with them.
Know exactly how to stop every one.



Every line checked by Stockfish

How to use this guide

Each page has two halves: **THE TRAP** (how to win with it) and **THE DEFENSE** (what to play when someone tries it on you).

● **winning / correct move** ● **the mistake**

1. Set the trap up on a real board and play it through with both colours.
2. Cover the move list and try to find the green-arrow move yourself.
3. Learn the defense too: at 400–1000 your opponents know many of these.
4. Start with your level, then move up.

400–600 ELO

1 Fool's Mate
2 Scholar's Mate
3 Back Rank Mate
4 Légal's Mate
5 Scholar's Mate (Queen f3)
6 Damiano's Trap
7 Petrov Queen Trap
8 Queen's Gambit Pawn Grab
9 Fried Liver Attack

600–800 ELO

10 Blackburne Shilling Trap
11 Stafford Gambit Trap
12 Englund Gambit Trap
13 Stafford Queen Trap
14 Caro-Kann Smothered Mate
15 From's Gambit Mate
16 Owen's Defense Mate
17 Dutch Defense Bishop Mate
18 Vienna Queen Trap
19 Philidor Double Attack
20 Philidor Hanham Trap

800–1000 ELO

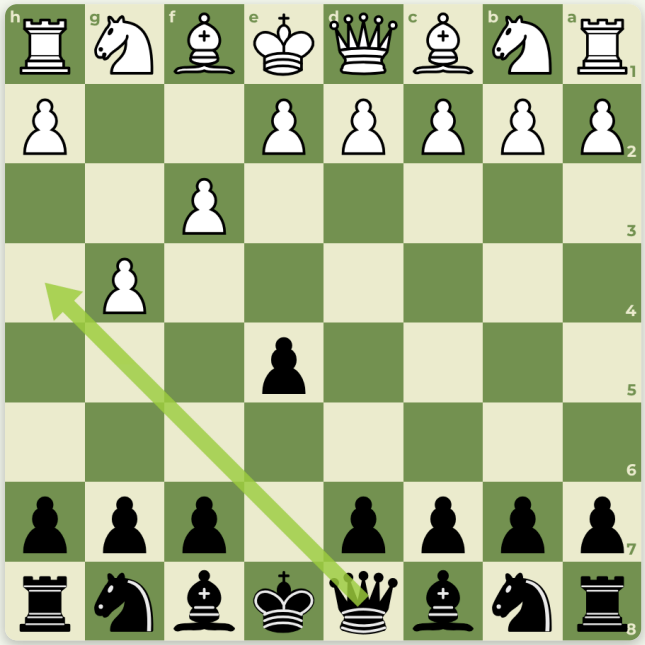
21 Elephant Trap
22 Kieninger Trap
23 Fishing Pole Trap
24 Lasker Trap
25 Siberian Trap
26 Noah's Ark Trap
27 Mortimer Trap
28 French Bishop Check Trap
29 Magnus Smith Trap
30 Tarrasch Trap

Fool's Mate

The **fastest** checkmate in chess. Only **2 moves**. Seriously.

THE TRAP

You play Black



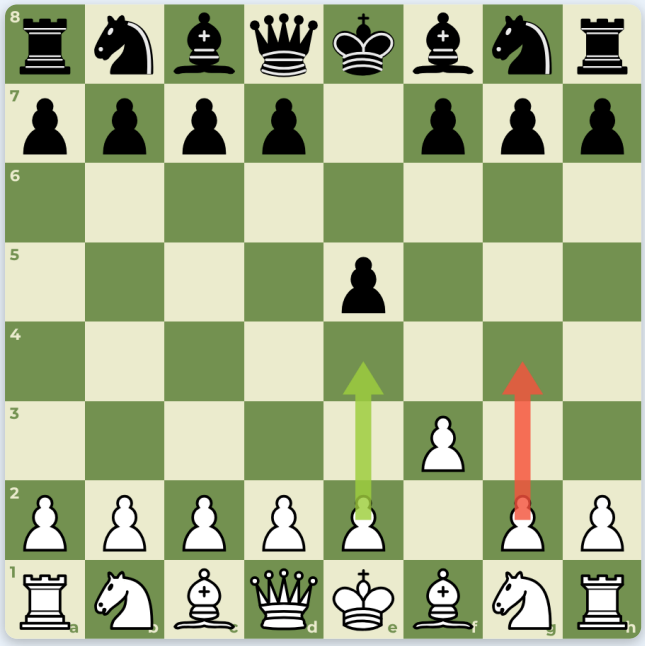
Winning move: **Qh4#**

1. **1. f3** White pushes the f-pawn. The king gets **weaker**.
2. **1... e5** We open a path for our **queen**.
3. **2. g4** Another pawn push. **Huge mistake!**
4. **2... Qh4#** Queen to h4. The king is **trapped**. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate in 2 moves**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



g4 **e4**

Instead of ~~g4~~, play 2. e4

Play e4 instead. If the queen checks, **g3 blocks**.

Line: **2. e4 Bc5 3. Nc3**

- Keep your **f and g pawns** home early.
- Start with **e4 or d4**, then knights.
- Open line to your king? **Close it**.

Remember: Don't push your **f and g pawns** early. · They are your king's **bodyguards**. · Open line to the king = **danger**.

Scholar's Mate

Checkmate in **4 moves**. Beginners fall for this **all the time**.

THE TRAP

You play White



Winning move: **Qxf7#**

1. **1. e4** Pawn to e4. This opens the door for our **queen** and **bishop**.
2. **1... e5** Black copies us. Totally normal.
3. **2. Bc4** Bishop out. It's **aiming at f7**.
4. Look at f7. Only the **king** protects it. That's the **weak spot**!
5. **2... Nc6** Black brings out a knight. Looks fine...
6. **3. Qh5** Queen out! Now **two pieces** attack f7.
7. **3... Nf6** Black attacks our queen... but **forgets about f7**!
8. **4. Qxf7#** Queen takes f7. The bishop protects her. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate in 4 moves**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



Nf6 **g6**

Instead of ~~Nf6~~, play 3... g6

Pawn to g6! It **kicks the queen** away.

Line: **3... g6 4. Qf3 Nf6 5. Ne2 Na5**

- Queen on h5? Play **...g6**.
- Queen on f3? Block with **...Nf6**.
- Early queen = **easy target**.

Remember: Queen + bishop attack **f7**. · If they forget to defend it: **game over**. · Playing Black? Stop it with **...g6** or **...Qe7**.

TRAP 3 400–600 ELO

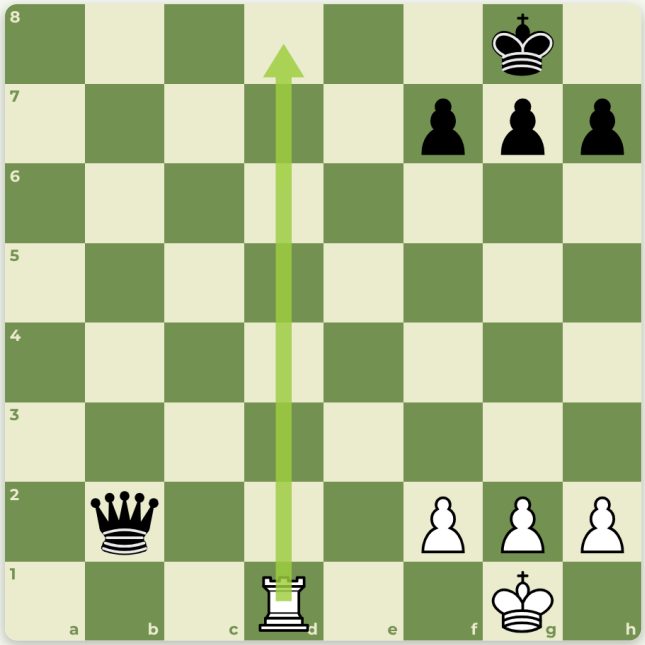
Middlegame pattern

Back Rank Mate

They have a **queen**. We have a rook. We still win in **1 move**.

THE TRAP

You play White



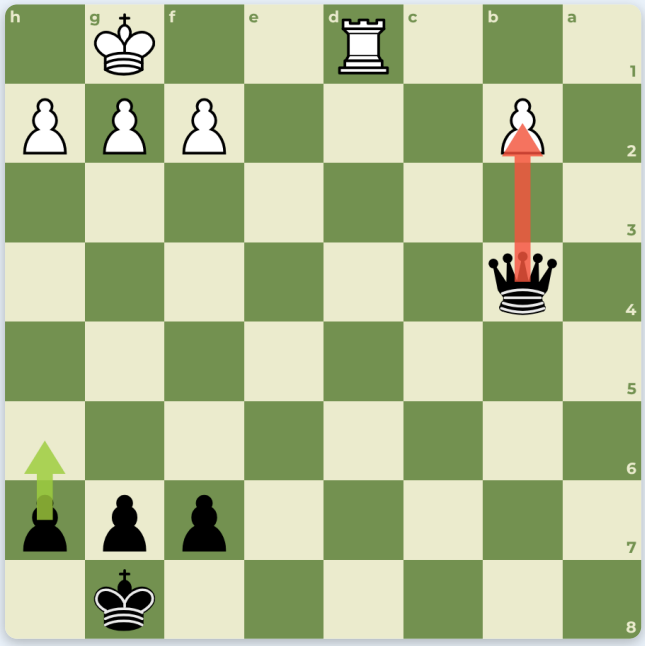
● Winning move: **Rd8#**

1. Black has a **queen**. Black is winning... right?
2. Look at their king. It's stuck **behind its own pawns**. No exit!
3. **1... Qxb2** Black gets greedy and grabs a pawn.
4. **2. Rd8#** Rook to the back row. The king **can't escape**. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Qxb2 ● **h6**

Instead of ~~Qxb2~~, play 1... h6

So first: pawn to h6. Now the king **can breathe**.

Line: **1... h6 2. Rd8+ Kh7**

- King stuck on the back row = **danger**.
- Make **one escape square** (h6 or g6).
- Then grab material **safely**.

Remember: King with **no exit** squares? Look at the back row. · One rook can **end the game**. · Protect yourself: give your king **one free square** (like h6).

Légal's Mate

Give away your **queen**... and **checkmate** 2 moves later.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Nxe5**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3** Normal start. Our knight **attacks e5**.
2. **2... d6** Black protects it with a pawn.
3. **3. Bc4** Bishop out. Aiming at f7, the **weak spot**.
4. **3... Bg4** Black pins our knight. 'If it moves, I **take your queen**!'
5. **4. Nc3 g6** We bring out a piece. Black plays a **slow move**. Now the trap is ready.
6. **5. Nxe5** Knight takes e5! We **leave our queen** to die!
7. **5... Bxd1** Black grabs the queen. **Big mistake.**
8. **6. Bxf7+** Bishop takes f7. **Check!**
9. **6... Ke7** The king has only **one square** to go.
10. **7. Nd5#** Knight to d5. **Checkmate!** Three small pieces beat a queen.

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● g6 ● **Nf6**

Instead of ~~g6~~, play 4... Nf6

Knight to f6! It guards **d5** and **g4**.

Line: **4... Nf6 5. Nxe5 Bxd1 6. Bxf7+ Ke7 7. Nd5+ Nxd5**

- Pinned their knight? Play **...Nf6** next.
- Guard **d5** and the trap dies.
- Never play **...g6** there.

Remember: A pin to the **queen** is not a real pin. · Sometimes giving the queen **wins the game**. · Free queen? First check for **checkmate**.

Scholar's Mate (Queen f3)

Black attacks the queen... and forgets f7.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Qxf7#**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6** Normal start. The bishop on c4 already aims at **f7**.
2. **3. Qf3** The queen joins: **two pieces** now hit f7.
3. **3... Nd4** ...Nd4 attacks the queen. Looks active, but **f7 is still weak**.
4. **4. Qxf7#** Queen takes f7, protected by the bishop: **checkmate**.

✅ **Checkmate in 4 moves**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Nd4 ● **Nf6**

Instead of ~~Nd4~~, play 3... Nf6

Block the queen's line to f7 with **...Nf6**. Your knight develops and f7 is safe.

- Queen on f3 and bishop on c4? Play **...Nf6**.
- An early queen is a target: develop and chase it.

Remember: Queen + bishop on f7 = mate threat. · Check f7 before every move.

Damiano's Trap

Defend e5 with ...f6? Lose your rook.

THE TRAP

You play White



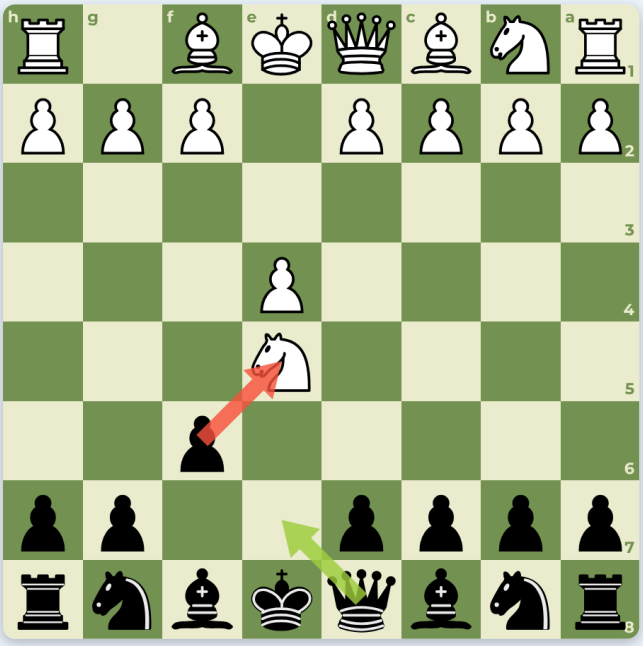
Winning move: **Nxe5**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3** The knight attacks e5.
2. **2... f6** ...f6 defends it, but **opens the king**.
3. **3. Nxe5** Knight sacrifice: **Nxe5**!
4. **3... fxe5** Black takes the knight: **the mistake**.
5. **4. Qh5+ g6** Queen check on h5; ...g6 blocks.
6. **5. Qxe5+ Qe7 6. Qxh8** Qxe5+ forks the king and the rook: White **wins the rook on h8**.

✅ **Wins the rook**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



fxe5 **Qe7**

Instead of ~~fxe5~~, play 3... Qe7

Don't take the knight. **...Qe7** hits it and the e4 pawn, and you win the pawn back with check.

Line: **3... Qe7 4. Nf3 Qxe4+**

- Defend e5 with **...Nc6**, never ...f6.
- If the knight lands on e5, answer **...Qe7**.

Remember: ...f6 weakens the e8–h5 diagonal. · Sacrifices on e5 work when the king is open.

Petrov Queen Trap

Copy White's moves... and lose your queen.

THE TRAP

You play White



Winning move: **Nc6+**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6** The Petrov: Black attacks e4 instead of defending e5.
2. **3. Nxe5** White takes e5.
3. **3... Nxe4** Black copies with ...Nxe4: **already a mistake**.
4. **4. Qe2** **Qe2!** The queen lines up on the e-file with the black king.
5. **4... Nf6** The knight runs away: **huge mistake**.
6. **5. Nc6+** **Nc6+**: discovered check from the queen, and the knight hits the queen on d8.

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



Nxe4 **d6**

Instead of ~~Nxe4~~, play 3... d6

First kick the knight with **...d6**. Only after Nf3 do you take on e4 safely.

Line: **3... d6 4. Nf3 Nxe4**

- In the Petrov: **...d6** first, then ...Nxe4.
- Never leave your king open on the e-file.

Remember: Pieces on one file with the king = discovered check danger. · Copying moves is not a plan.

Queen's Gambit Pawn Grab

Keep the extra pawn? Lose your rook.

THE TRAP

You play White



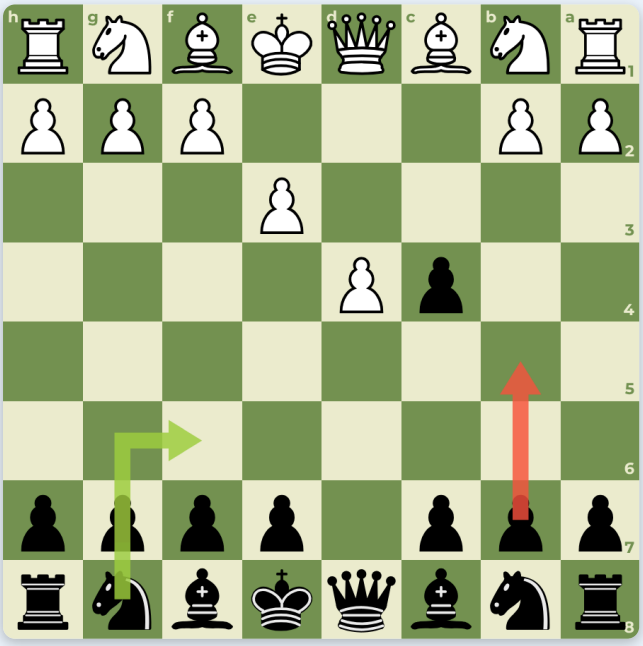
Winning move: **Qf3**

1. **1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4** Queen's Gambit Accepted: Black takes c4.
2. **3. e3 b5** ...b5 tries to **keep the pawn**.
3. **4. a4 c6** a4 attacks it; ...c6 defends.
4. **5. axb5 cxb5** After the trades the long diagonal to **a8** is open: **mistake**.
5. **6. Qf3** **Qf3!** hits the rook on a8. Black can't save everything.

✅ **Wins the rook**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



b5 **Nf6**

Instead of ~~b5~~, play 3... Nf6

Don't hold on to the pawn. Develop with **...Nf6** and **...e6**: you are fine.

Line: **3... Nf6 4. Bxc4 e6**

- In the QGA, give the pawn back.
- Development beats pawn grabbing.

Remember: Greedy pawn grabs open lines. · Look for long diagonals to a corner rook.

Fried Liver Attack

Take back with the knight? Your king gets roasted.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Bxd5+**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6** Two Knights Defense.
2. **4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5** Ng5 attacks **f7**; ...d5 blocks the bishop.
3. **5... Nxd5** ...Nxd5 takes back: **risky**, it allows a sacrifice on f7.
4. **6. Nxf7 Kxf7** **Nxf7!** Knight sacrifice; the king must take.
5. **7. Qf3+ Kg8** Qf3+ and the king hides on g8: **the mistake** (...Ke6 was forced).
6. **8. Bxd5+ Qxd5 9. Qxd5+** **Bxd5+!** If the queen takes, Qxd5+ wins it: White is a queen up.

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Nxd5 ● **Na5**

Instead of ~~Nxd5~~, play 5... Na5

Don't recapture. **...Na5** kicks the bishop; you give a pawn but get fast, active pieces.

Line: **5... Na5 6. Bb5+ c6 7. dxc6 bxc6**

- After exd5, play **...Na5**.
- Never let the f7 square be hit twice.

Remember: Ng5 + Bc4 = pressure on f7. · A king in the centre is a target.

Blackburne Shilling Trap

This move looks like a **blunder**... but it ends in **checkmate**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



● Winning move: **Nf3#**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nd4** Knight to d4. Now e5 looks **free**...
2. **4. Nxe5** White takes it. **Here we go.**
3. **4... Qg5** Queen to g5! She hits the knight **and** g2.
4. **5. Nxf7 Qxg2** White grabs f7. We grab g2!
5. **6. Rf1 Qxe4+** The rook runs. Queen takes e4. **Check!**
6. **7. Be2 Nf3#** Knight to f3. The bishop is **pinned**. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● Nxe5 ● **Nxd4**

Instead of ~~Nxe5~~, play 4. Nxd4

Instead, **take the knight**!

Line: **4. Nxd4 exd4 5. O-O**

- Knight on d4? **Take it**, not e5.
- Free pawns can be **poison**.
- Castle early, stay **safe**.

Remember: If they grab e5, play **...Qg5!** · Ignore the knight. **Attack g2**. · ...Nd4 is risky. It works when they **grab e5**.

Stafford Gambit Trap

White takes our **queen**... and gets **checkmated** right away.

THE TRAP

You play Black



● Winning move: **Nxe4**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nxe5 Nc6** We give a pawn. The **Stafford Gambit**.
2. **4. Nxc6 dxc6 5. d3 Bc5** Our bishop aims at **f2**.
3. **6. Bg5** White pins our knight to the queen.
4. **6... Nxe4** We move it anyway! **Take my queen!**
5. **7. Bxd8 Bxf2+** White takes it. Bishop takes f2. **Check!**
6. **8. Ke2 Bg4#** Bishop to g4. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● Bg5 ● **Be2**

Instead of ~~Bg5~~, play 6. Be2

Bishop to e2. It guards **g4** and our king.

Line: **6. Be2 Ng4 7. Bxg4**

- Against the Stafford: **Be2**, not Bg5.
- Guard **f2** and g4.
- Then castle and **stay calm**.

Remember: Bishop on c5 = **pressure on f2**. · Pinned to the queen? You can **still move**. · Before taking a queen, check for **checks**.

Englund Gambit Trap

White takes a **free pawn**. 6 moves later: **checkmate**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



● Winning move: **Qc1#**

1. **1. d4 e5** We throw a pawn at them. The **Englund Gambit**.
2. **2. dxe5 Nc6 3. Nf3** White takes and protects it.
3. **3... Qe7** Queen to e7. We attack e5 **again**.
4. **4. Bf4** White protects it one more time.
5. **4... Qb4+** Queen to b4. **Check!** And she's eyeing **b2**.
6. **5. Bd2 Qxb2** We take b2. Now we attack the **rook** in the corner.
7. **6. Bc3** White attacks our queen. **This is the mistake.**
8. **6... Bb4** Bishop to b4! Their bishop is now **pinned**.
9. **7. Qd2** White protects with the queen.
10. **7... Bxc3** We take the bishop. Our queen **doesn't care**.
11. **8. Qxc3** White takes back... **and walks into it**.
12. **8... Qc1#** Queen to c1. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● Bc3 ● **Nc3**

Instead of ~~Bc3~~, play 6. Nc3

Knight to c3! Next, our rook **hunts the queen**.

Line: **6. Nc3 Bb4 7. Rb1 Qa3 8. Nd5**

- Queen on b2? Play **Nc3**, then Rb1.
- Never **Bc3** there: it gets pinned.
- Chase the **greedy queen**!

Remember: Gambit = give a pawn to **attack fast**. · Pin pieces to the king with your **bishop**. · Every move, ask: what are their **checks**?

Stafford Queen Trap

Take the free knight? Your queen falls.

THE TRAP

You play Black



● Winning move: **Bxf2+**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nxe5 Nc6** The Stafford Gambit: Black gives the e5 pawn.
2. **4. Nxc6 dxc6** Knights trade; Black's bishops open up.
3. **5. e5 Ne4** e5 kicks the knight, it jumps to **e4**.
4. **6. d3 Bc5** d3 attacks it... and Black **ignores it**: ...Bc5!
5. **7. dxe4** White takes the knight: **the mistake**.
6. **7... Bxf2+ 8. Ke2** **Bxf2+**! The king must walk to e2.
7. **8... Bg4+** **Bg4+** and the queen on d1 falls.

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● e5 ● **d3**

Instead of ~~e5~~, play 5. d3

Don't push e5. Play **d3**, **Be2** and castle: you stay a pawn up and safe.

Line: **5. d3 Bc5 6. Be2**

- Against the Stafford: d3, Be2, O-O.
- Don't chase the knight with e5.

Remember: Bishops on c5 and g4 hunt the white king. · A 'free' piece can be bait.

Caro-Kann Smothered Mate

One natural knight move: checkmate.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Nd6#**

1. **1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Nd7** Caro-Kann main line.
2. **5. Qe2** **Qe2**: a quiet move that sets the trap.
3. **5... Ngf6** ...Ngf6, the most natural move: **the mistake**.
4. **6. Nd6#** **Nd6#**! The e7 pawn is pinned, the king has no squares: **smothered mate**.

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Ngf6 ● **Ndf6**

Instead of ~~Ngf6~~, play 5... Ndf6

Develop the **other** knight: **...Ndf6** keeps d7 free for your king and no mate exists.

- With White's queen on e2, play **...Ndf6**.
- Don't block your king's last escape square.

Remember: A pinned pawn can't take. · Knights love squares next to a boxed-in king.

From's Gambit Mate

Queen sacrifice, then checkmate.

THE TRAP

You play Black



Winning move: **Qxg3+**

1. **1. f4 e5** From's Gambit against the Bird.
2. **2. fxe5 d6 3. exd6 Bxd6** Black gives a pawn; the bishop on d6 now aims at **g3 and h2**.
3. **4. Nc3** Nc3, a normal move: **the mistake**.
4. **4... Qh4+ 5. g3** **Qh4+**; g3 blocks.
5. **5... Qxg3+ 6. hxg3** **Qxg3+!** Queen sacrifice.
6. **6... Bxg3#** Bishop takes on g3: **checkmate**.

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



Nc3 **Nf3**

Instead of ~~Nc3~~, play 4. Nf3

Play **Nf3**: the knight covers h4, so the queen check never comes.

- After ...Bd6, play **Nf3** at once.
- With f4 played, watch the e1–h4 diagonal.

Remember: f4 weakens the e1–h4 diagonal. · Queen + bishop on g3 = mate pattern.

Owen's Defense Mate

Black wins the rook... and gets mated.

THE TRAP

You play White



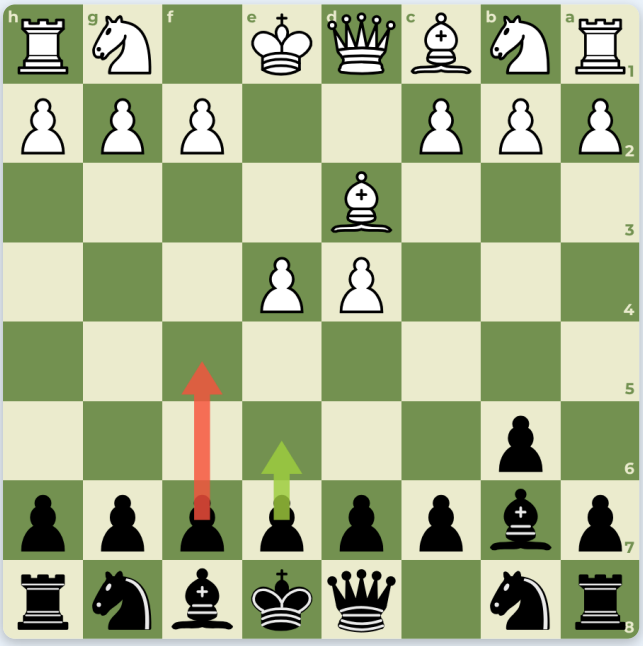
Winning move: **gxh7+**

1. **1. e4 b6 2. d4 Bb7 3. Bd3** Owen's Defense: Black's bishop eyes e4.
2. **3... f5** ...f5 attacks e4 but **opens the king**.
3. **4. exf5 Bxg2** White takes; Black grabs g2 and attacks the rook.
4. **5. Qh5+ g6 6. fxg6** Qh5+! ...g6 blocks and the pawn takes on g6.
5. **6... Nf6** ...Nf6 attacks the queen: **the mistake**.
6. **7. gxh7+ Nxh5** gxh7+ is a discovered check; Black takes the queen.
7. **8. Bg6#** **Bg6#**: the king is trapped by its own pieces.

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



f5 **e6**

Instead of f5, play 3... e6

Skip ...f5. **...e6** and **...c5** fight for the centre without weakening the king.

Line: **3... e6 4. Nf3 c5**

- Don't open your king with ...f5.
- Develop first, grab pawns later.

Remember: Opening the h5–e8 diagonal is dangerous. · Discovered checks beat queen attacks.

Dutch Defense Bishop Mate

Chase the bishop with pawns? Get mated.

THE TRAP

You play White



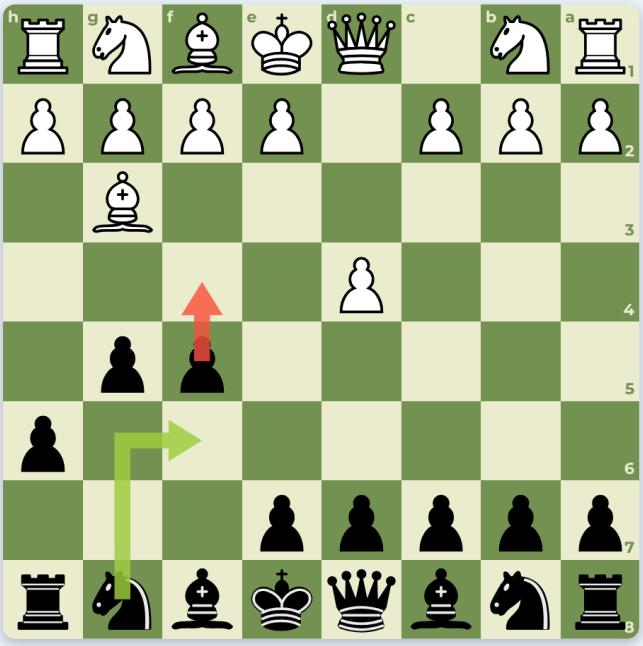
● Winning move: **Qxh5+**

1. **1. d4 f5 2. Bg5** The bishop jumps to g5.
2. **2... h6 3. Bh4 g5 4. Bg3** Black chases it with ...h6 and ...g5.
3. **4... f4 5. e3** ...f4 tries to **trap the bishop**.
4. **5... h5 6. Bd3** ...h5 threatens ...h4; White's other bishop aims at **g6**.
5. **6... Rh6** ...Rh6 guards g6: **the mistake**.
6. **7. Qxh5+ Rxh5** **Qxh5+!** Queen sacrifice; the rook takes.
7. **8. Bg6#** **Bg6#**: checkmate.

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● f4 ● **Nf6**

Instead of ~~f4~~, play 4... Nf6

Stop pushing pawns. **...Nf6** develops and guards h5 and g4.

- In the Dutch, develop **...Nf6** early.
- Don't push all your kingside pawns.

Remember: Pawn storms in front of your own king are risky. · The e8–h5 diagonal is the Dutch's weak spot.

Vienna Queen Trap

Take the knight? Checkmate on f7.

THE TRAP

You play White



Winning move: **Qxf7#**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Bc4 Nxe4** Vienna Game: Black grabs e4.
2. **4. Qh5 Nd6** Qh5 threatens **Qxf7#**; ...Nd6 blocks.
3. **5. Bb3 Nc6** The bishop keeps aiming at f7.
4. **6. Nb5** Nb5 attacks the knight on d6.
5. **6... Nxb5** Black takes: **the mistake**. Now nothing guards f7.
6. **7. Qxf7#** **Qxf7#**: checkmate.

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



Nxb5 **g6**

Instead of ~~Nxb5~~, play 6... g6

Kick the queen first with **...g6**, then ...f5. Black keeps the extra pawn.

Line: **6... g6 7. Qf3 f5**

- Never let your only f7 defender be traded.
- Kick an early queen with tempo.

Remember: The knight on d6 is f7's only guard. · Count the defenders of f7 every move.

Philidor Double Attack

Block the queen? Lose a pawn and the rook's safety.

THE TRAP

You play White



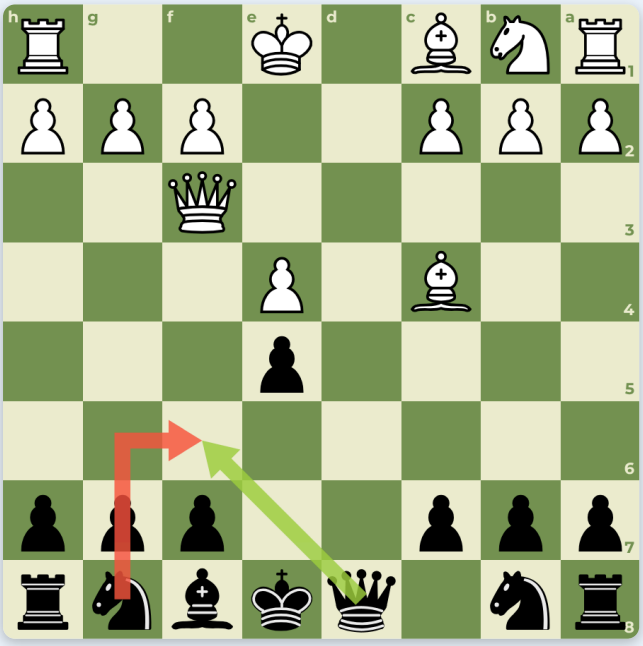
● Winning move: **Qb3**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Bg4** Philidor: Black pins the knight.
2. **4. dxe5 Bxf3 5. Qxf3 dxe5** Trades bring White's queen to **f3**.
3. **6. Bc4** Queen + bishop both hit **f7**.
4. **6... Nf6** ...Nf6 blocks the queen: **the mistake**.
5. **7. Qb3** **Qb3!** Double attack on f7 and b7.
6. **7... Qe7 8. Qxb7** Black saves f7; White takes b7 and hits the rook.

✅ **Wins material**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Nf6 ● **Qf6**

Instead of ~~Nf6~~, play 6... Qf6

Guard f7 with the queen: **...Qf6** stops the queen trick.

- Queen + bishop on f7? Defend it with **...Qf6**.
- Avoid ...Bxf3 when it helps White's queen.

Remember: Bxf3 gives White a strong queen. · Look for double attacks on f7 and b7.

Philidor Hanham Trap

One natural bishop move loses f7.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Qd5**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7** Philidor, Hanham line.
2. **4. Bc4** The bishop aims at **f7**.
3. **4... Be7** ...Be7 looks natural: **inaccurate**.
4. **5. dxe5 dxe5** Pawns trade on e5: **the mistake**.
5. **6. Qd5** **Qd5!** Mate threat on f7. Black must give material.

✅ **Wins material**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Be7 ● **c6**

Instead of ~~Be7~~, play 4... c6

...c6 first: it takes the d5 square away from the white queen.

- In the Hanham, play **...c6** before ...Be7.
- Take away the queen's landing square.

Remember: Bishop on c4 + queen on d5 = f7 attack. · Open lines help the side that is ahead in development.

Elephant Trap

White thinks they **won a pawn**. Really, they just **lost a piece**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



● Winning move: **Nxd5**

1. **1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Nbd7** White pins our knight. We **quietly** set the trap.
2. **5. cxd5 exd5 6. Nxd5** White grabs d5. 'Your knight is pinned!'
3. **6... Nxd5** Surprise! We take anyway and **give our queen**.
4. **7. Bxd8 Bb4+** White takes it. Bishop **check**!
5. **8. Qd2 Bxd2+ 9. Kxd2** Only the queen can block. We **take it**.
6. **9... Kxd8** Then the bishop. We're **a whole piece up**!

✅ **Wins a piece**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● Nxd5 ● **e3**

Instead of ~~Nxd5~~, play 6. e3

Play **e3**. Calm and solid.

Line: **6. e3 c6 7. Bd3**

- Pinned to the queen = **not** fully pinned.
- Free pawn? Check what **they** get.
- Solid moves win **at your level**.

Remember: A pinned knight can **still move**. · Lose your queen, take **theirs** + a piece. · Free pawn? Count the **checks** first.

Kieninger Trap

White takes our **bishop**. Next move: **checkmate**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



Winning move: **Ngxe5**

1. **1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 Ng4** We give a pawn. The **Budapest Gambit**.
2. **4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bf4 Bb4+ 6. Nbd2 Qe7** Now **three** pieces hit e5.
3. **7. a3** White attacks our bishop.
4. **7... Ngxe5** We ignore it and take e5! **Leave the bishop.**
5. **8. axb4** White takes the free bishop...
6. The e2 pawn is **pinned**. The king is **boxed in**.
7. **8... Nd3#** Knight to d3. **Smothered checkmate!**

✅ **Smothered checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



axb4 **Nxe5**

Instead of ~~axb4~~, play 8. Nxe5

Don't grab the bishop yet. Trade on e5 and play **e3**: your king gets air and ...Nd3# is gone.

Line: **8. Nxe5 Nxe5 9. e3**

- A 'free' bishop on b4? Check for ...Nd3# first.
- Give your king air with **e3**.

Remember: Pin the **e2 pawn** with your queen. · King boxed in by its own pieces = **knight mate**. · Free bishop? Check for **mate** first.

Fishing Pole Trap

Throw your knight as **bait**... and catch a **checkmate**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



● Winning move: **Qh1#**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nf6 4. O-O Ng4** Knight to g4. It's our **fishing pole**!
2. **5. h3 h5** White kicks it. We **leave it there**.
3. **6. hxg4 hxg4** White bites! Now the h-file is **open**.
4. **7. Ne1 Qh4** Queen to h4. **Threat:** mate on h1!
5. **8. f3 g3** Pawn to g3. Now **nothing** stops mate.
6. **9. Bxc6 Qh1#** Queen to h1. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● hxg4 ● **c3**

Instead of ~~hxg4~~, play 6. c3

Don't take! Play **c3**, then d4.

Line: **6. c3 d6 7. d4**

- Free knight next to your king? **Bait**.
- Don't open the **h-file**.
- Play the **center** instead.

Remember: Taking the bait **opens the h-file**. · Rook + queen on an open file = **mate**. · Risky trap: it only works if they **take the bait**.

Lasker Trap

Promote a pawn to a **knight**? Yes. And it **wins the queen**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



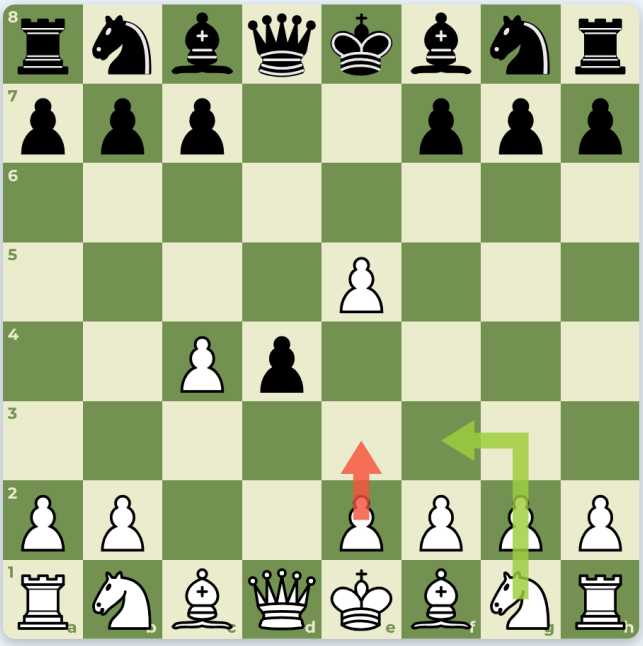
● Winning move: **fxg1=N+**

1. **1. d4 d5 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 d4 4. e3** We push to d4. White attacks it: **mistake!**
2. **4... Bb4+ 5. Bd2 dxe3** Bishop check, then we take e3.
3. **6. Bxb4 exf2+ 7. Ke2** White grabs our bishop. Pawn takes f2. **Check!**
4. **7... fxg1=N+** And it becomes... a **KNIGHT**! With check!
5. A queen gives **no check**. The knight **does**.
6. **8. Rxg1 Bg4+** White takes it. Bishop check **hits the queen**.
7. **9. Ke1 Qxd1+** The king steps back... and we **take their queen**!

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



● e3 ● **Nf3**

Instead of ~~e3~~, play 4. Nf3

Play **Nf3**. Just develop.

Line: **4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Nbd2 Nge7 6. Nb3**

- Against the Albin: **Nf3**, not e3.
- Win the d4 pawn **later**.
- Knights before pawns.

Remember: Promote to a knight when it gives **check**. · Checks first, captures second. · Against the Albin, avoid **e3**.

Siberian Trap

Their queen **looks** safe. One knight jump: **checkmate**.

THE TRAP

You play Black



Winning move: **Nd4**

1. **1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Qc7** The Smith-Morra Gambit. Our queen eyes **h2**.
2. **7. O-O Nf6 8. Qe2 Ng4** Knight to g4. **Two pieces** hit h2.
3. **9. h3** White kicks it. **Natural... but wrong!**
4. **9... Nd4** Knight to d4! It attacks the **queen**.
5. **10. Nxd4** White takes it... now **nobody guards h2**.
6. **10... Qh2#** Queen takes h2. **Checkmate!**

✅ **Checkmate**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



h3 **Rd1**

Instead of ~~h3~~, play 9. Rd1

Rook to d1. Now our queen has **f1** to escape.

Line: **9. Rd1 Bc5 10. Nb5**

- Knight g4 + queen c7? **No h3**.
- Give your queen an **escape square**.
- Attack their queen **first**.

Remember: Queen + knight vs **h2** = danger. · Kill or distract the **defender**. · Attack two things at once.

Noah's Ark Trap

Take back with the queen? Lose your bishop.

THE TRAP

You play Black



Winning move: **c4**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 d6 5. d4** Ruy Lopez: White pushes d4.
2. **5... b5 6. Bb3** ...b5 kicks the bishop to b3.
3. **6... Nxd4 7. Nxd4 exd4** Knights trade; Black grabs d4.
4. **8. Qxd4** Qxd4 takes back: **the mistake**.
5. **8... c5 9. Qd5 Be6 10. Qc6+ Bd7 11. Qd5** ...c5 and ...Be6 chase the queen away.
6. **11... c4** **...c4!** The bishop on b3 is **trapped** by the pawns: Noah's Ark.

✅ **Wins the bishop**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



Qxd4 **c3**

Instead of ~~Qxd4~~, play 8. c3

Don't recapture with the queen. Gambit with **c3**: your pieces come out fast.

Line: **8. c3 dxc3 9. Nxc3**

- In the Ruy, don't play Qxd4 there.
- Give your bishop an escape square (a4 or c2).

Remember: Bishop on b3 + pawns a6, b5, c4 = trapped. · Chase the queen with tempo.

Mortimer Trap

Grab the e5 pawn? Lose a piece.

THE TRAP

You play Black



Winning move: **Qa5+**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nf6 4. d3** Ruy Lopez, quiet d3 line.
2. **4... Ne7** ...Ne7 leaves e5 hanging **on purpose**.
3. **5. Nxe5** White grabs the pawn: **the mistake**.
4. **5... c6 6. Ba4** ...c6 kicks the bishop away.
5. **6... Qa5+** **...Qa5+!** Check, and the queen also hits the knight on e5.

✅ **Wins a piece**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (White)



Nxe5 **Nc3**

Instead of ~~Nxe5~~, play 5. Nc3

Ignore the pawn. **Nc3** (or castling) keeps your pieces safe.

- Don't take e5 when ...c6 and ...Qa5+ are coming.
- Loose pieces + queen checks = forks.

Remember: Queen checks can hide a second attack. · A 'free' pawn may be bait.

French Bishop Check Trap

Grab two pawns? Lose your queen.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Bb5+**

1. **1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6** French Advance: Black attacks d4.
2. **6. Bd3 cxd4 7. cxd4** Bd3 leaves d4 **weak on purpose**.
3. **7... Nxd4 8. Nxd4** Black grabs d4; the knights trade.
4. **8... Qxd4** ...Qxd4 takes back: **the mistake**.
5. **9. Bb5+** **Bb5+!** Check, and the bishop has left the d-file: White's queen on d1 now **hits the queen on d4**.

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Nxd4 ● **Bd7**

Instead of ~~Nxd4~~, play 7... Bd7

Play **...Bd7** first: it covers b5, so the trick no longer works.

- Before grabbing d4, stop Bb5+ with **...Bd7**.
- Check every check your opponent has.

Remember: Watch for discovered attacks on your queen. · A queen in front of an enemy queen is in danger.

Magnus Smith Trap

Take the pawn? Your queen is gone.

THE TRAP

You play White



Winning move: **Bxf7+**

1. **1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 d6** Open Sicilian.
2. **6. Bc4 g6** Bc4, and Black fianchettos with ...g6: **risky**.
3. **7. Nxc6 bxc6** White trades knights on c6.
4. **8. e5** **e5!** attacks the knight on f6.
5. **8... dxe5** ...dxe5 takes: **the mistake**.
6. **9. Bxf7+ Kxf7 10. Qxd8** **Bxf7+!** The king must take, and the queen on d8 falls.

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



g6 **e6**

Instead of ~~g6~~, play 6... e6

Against Bc4, play **...e6**: it blunts the bishop and the trick never appears.

- Against Bc4 in the Sicilian: **...e6**.
- After e5, don't open the d-file with ...dxe5.

Remember: Queens facing each other on the d-file = danger. · Bxf7+ can deflect the king from defending.

Tarrasch Trap

A rook sacrifice wins the queen.

THE TRAP

You play White



● Winning move: **Rxe4**

1. **1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. d4 b5 7. Bb3 d5 8. dxe5 Be6 9. c3 Be7 10. Re1 O-O** Open Ruy Lopez main line.
2. **11. Nd4** Nd4 attacks the bishop on e6.
3. **11... Qd7** ...Qd7 defends: **the mistake**: the queens now face each other.
4. **12. Nxe6 fxe6** White trades on e6.
5. **13. Rxe4** **Rxe4!** Rook takes the knight.
6. **13... dxe4** ...dxe4 takes back and opens the d-file.
7. **14. Qxd7** **Qxd7**: the queen falls.

✅ **Wins the queen**

🛡 THE DEFENSE

When they try it on you (Black)



● Qd7 ● **Nxe5**

Instead of ~~Qd7~~, play 11... Nxe5

...Nxe5 removes a key attacker and keeps the queens off the d-file.

- Don't put your queen opposite White's queen.
- Trade active attackers when you can.

Remember: Pieces on an open file with the queens = tactics. · A pawn that moves can open a line.

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